

Kan Xu

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EMPLOYMENT

W. P. Carey School of Business, Arizona State University	Tempe, AZ
Assistant Professor of Information Systems	2024-Present
- Affiliated Member, Center for AI and Data Analytics (AIDA)	
- Graduate Faculty, Data Science, Analytics and Engineering	
Lecturer in Information Systems	2023-2024

EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania	Philadelphia, PA
Ph.D. in Economics	2018-2023
University of Chicago	Chicago, IL
M.S. in Statistics	2015-2017
Tsinghua University	Beijing, China
B.A. in Economics	2013-2015
B.S. in Mathematics	2011-2015

WORKING PAPERS

Two-Stage Maximum Score Estimator

Wayne Gao, Sheng Xu, Kan Xu

Uniformly Conservative Exploration in Reinforcement Learning

Kan Xu, Wanqiao Xu, Hamsa Bastani, Osbert Bastani

Under Review, **Operations Research**

- Preliminary version in **AISTATS**, 2023

Match Made with Matrix Completion: Efficient Learning under Matching Interference

Zhiyuan Tang, Wanning Chen, Kan Xu

Major Revision, **Operations Research**

- 1st Place, POMS-HK Best Student Paper Award (Tang, 2025)

- Extended abstract in **EC**, 2025

JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

Group-Sparse Matrix Factorization for Transfer Learning of Word Embeddings

Kan Xu, Xuanyi Zhao, Hamsa Bastani, Osbert Bastani

Management Science, Accepted

- Preliminary version in **ICML**, 2021

Optimal Multitask Linear Regression and Contextual Bandits under Sparse Heterogeneity

Xinmeng Huang, Kan Xu, Donghwan Lee, Hamed Hassani, Hamsa Bastani, Edgar Dobriban

Journal of the American Statistical Association, 2025

Multitask Learning and Bandits via Robust Statistics

Kan Xu, Hamsa Bastani

Management Science, 2025

- 3rd Place, IBM Service Science Best Student Paper Award (2022)

A Stratified Optimization Method for a Multivariate Marine Environmental Monitoring Network in the Yangtze River Estuary and Its Adjacent Sea

Bing-Bo Gao, Jin-Feng Wang, Hai-Mei Fan, Kan Xu, Mao-Gui Hu, Zi-Yue Chen

International Journal of Geographical Information Science, 2015

REFEREED CONFERENCE PUBLICATIONS

Adaptive Combinatorial Experimental Design: Pareto Optimality for Decision-Making and Inference

Hongrui Xie, Junyu Cao, Kan Xu

International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Statistics (AISTATS), 2026

Match Made with Matrix Completion: Efficient Offline and Online Learning in Matching Markets

Zhiyuan Tang, Wanning Chen, Kan Xu

Proceedings of the 26th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC), 2025

Stochastic Bandits with ReLU Neural Networks

Kan Xu, Hamsa Bastani, Surbhi Goel, Osbert Bastani

International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML), 2024

Uniformly Conservative Exploration in Reinforcement Learning

Wanqiao Xu, Jason Yecheng Ma, Kan Xu, Hamsa Bastani, Osbert Bastani

International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Statistics (AISTATS), 2023

Group-Sparse Matrix Factorization for Transfer Learning of Word Embeddings

Kan Xu, Xuanyi Zhao, Hamsa Bastani, Osbert Bastani

International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML), 2021

WORKSHOPS

Robust Generalization of Quadratic Neural Networks via Function Identification

Kan Xu, Hamsa Bastani, Osbert Bastani

ICML Uncertainty and Robustness in Deep Learning Workshop, 2021

ICML Overparameterization: Pitfalls & Opportunities Workshop, 2021

STUDENTS

Zhiyuan Tang, UTD Jindal OM PhD (Advisor: Yining Wang)

Yu Qin, ASU Carey IS PhD (Advisor: Olivia Liu Sheng)

- Placement: Assistant Professor, CUHK Business School DOT, 2026

Hongrui Xie, USTC Undergraduate

- Placement: PhD student, USC Marshall OM, 2026

Jiajun Cheng, Duke Master

- Placement: PhD student, University of Arizona Eller IS, 2026

Haozhe Xu, XJTU Undergraduate

- Placement: PhD student, HKU Business School IIM, 2026

Sihan Wang, USTC Undergraduate

- Placement: PhD student, Yale SOM OM, 2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

W. P. Carey School of Business, Arizona State University

Instructor, CIS 404 Programming Analytics and AI Business (Undergrad)

Fall 2025

Instructor, CIS 325 Programming for Business Analytics (Undergrad)

Spring 2024, Spring 2025

The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania

Teaching Assistant, OIDD 612 Business Analytics (MBA)

Fall 2021

University of Pennsylvania

Teaching Assistant, ECON 705 Econometrics I (PhD)

Fall 2020

SERVICE

Journal Reviewer

Management Science, Operations Research, Manufacturing & Service Operations Management, Information Systems Research, MIS Quarterly, Journal of the American Statistical Association, Journal of the Royal

Statistical Society: Series B, Annals of Statistics, Production and Operations Management, Journal of Machine Learning Research, INFORMS Journal on Computing, ACM Transactions on Management Information Systems, Journal of Computational and Graphical Statistics, European Journal of Operational Research, Journal of Financial Counseling and Planning

Conference Reviewer or Program Committee

AISTATS, ICLR, NeurIPS, ICML, AAAI, CIST, ICIS, INFORMS Workshop on Data Science, MSOM SIG

Arizona State University

Brown Bag Seminar Series Organizer

Faculty Recruiting Committee

Fall 2025

2024-2025

INVITED TALKS

2025 USC AIM Conf; HBS EEO Workshop; ACM SIGMETRICS; ASU School of Mathematical and Natural Sciences;

2024 Rotman Young Scholar Seminar; Michigan Workshop on Unstructured Data and Language Models; SJTU Antai MS; CityU College of Business IS; HKUST IEDA; HKU Business School IIM; Miami Herbert MS;

2023 CUHK Business School DSME; UTD Jindal OM; ASU Carey IS; Fudan School of Management IS; Chinese Academy of Sciences IGSNRR; ASU Carey Econ; MIT CODE; Conf on AI, ML and BA;

2022 UC Davis GSM; Cornell Johnson OTIM; JHU Carey OM;

AWARDS, HONORS, AND GRANTS

3rd Place, IBM Service Science Best Student Paper Award

Xingmei Zhang & Yongge Dai Fellowship

2022

2020-2021, 2022-2023

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Moelis & Company

Data Science Intern

New York, NY

Summer 2020

University of Chicago, Department of Economics

Research Specialist

Chicago, IL

2017-2018